Method 365 User Manual

Electronic signatures for Jupiter Research Services (JRS) at **https://esign.method365sign.com**.

Version 2.0 · October 2026 · Document JRS-VAL-M365-UM-002 · Screenshots use fictional sample data.

1. Overview

Method 365 turns your files into an agreement, sends it to each signer, and keeps the completed, digitally signed PDF with a full audit trail. Every agreement follows the same path:

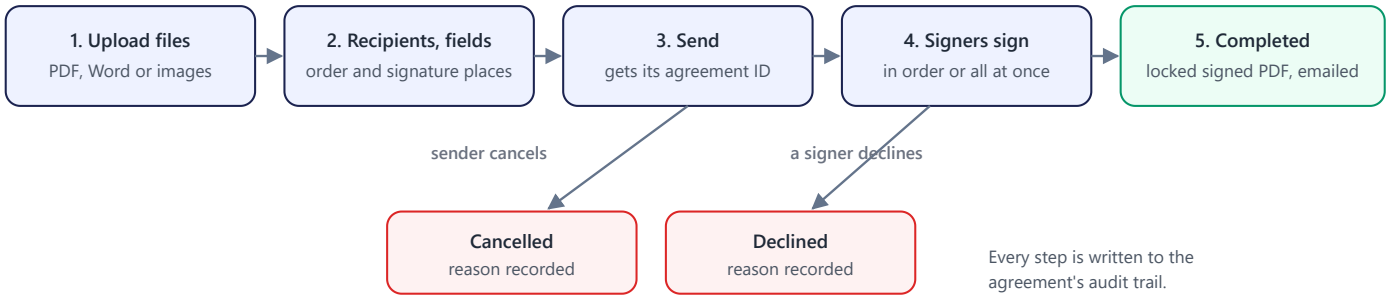


Figure 1. The life of an agreement.

ROLE	WHAT THEY DO
Sender	Prepares and sends agreements; sees the ones they sent and those sent to them.
Administrator	Also manages users, companies, support tickets, the system log and backups.
System administrator	One named administrator who can also update and restart the server.
Signer with an account	JRS staff: signs after signing in; can view agreements sent to them.
Outside signer	Someone without an account: signs with a temporary password emailed to them.

2. Getting started

Signing in

1. Open **https://esign.method365sign.com**.
2. Enter your email (your sign-in ID) and password. Click **Show** to check what you typed.
3. Enter the 6-digit code emailed to you. It works once and expires after 10 minutes.

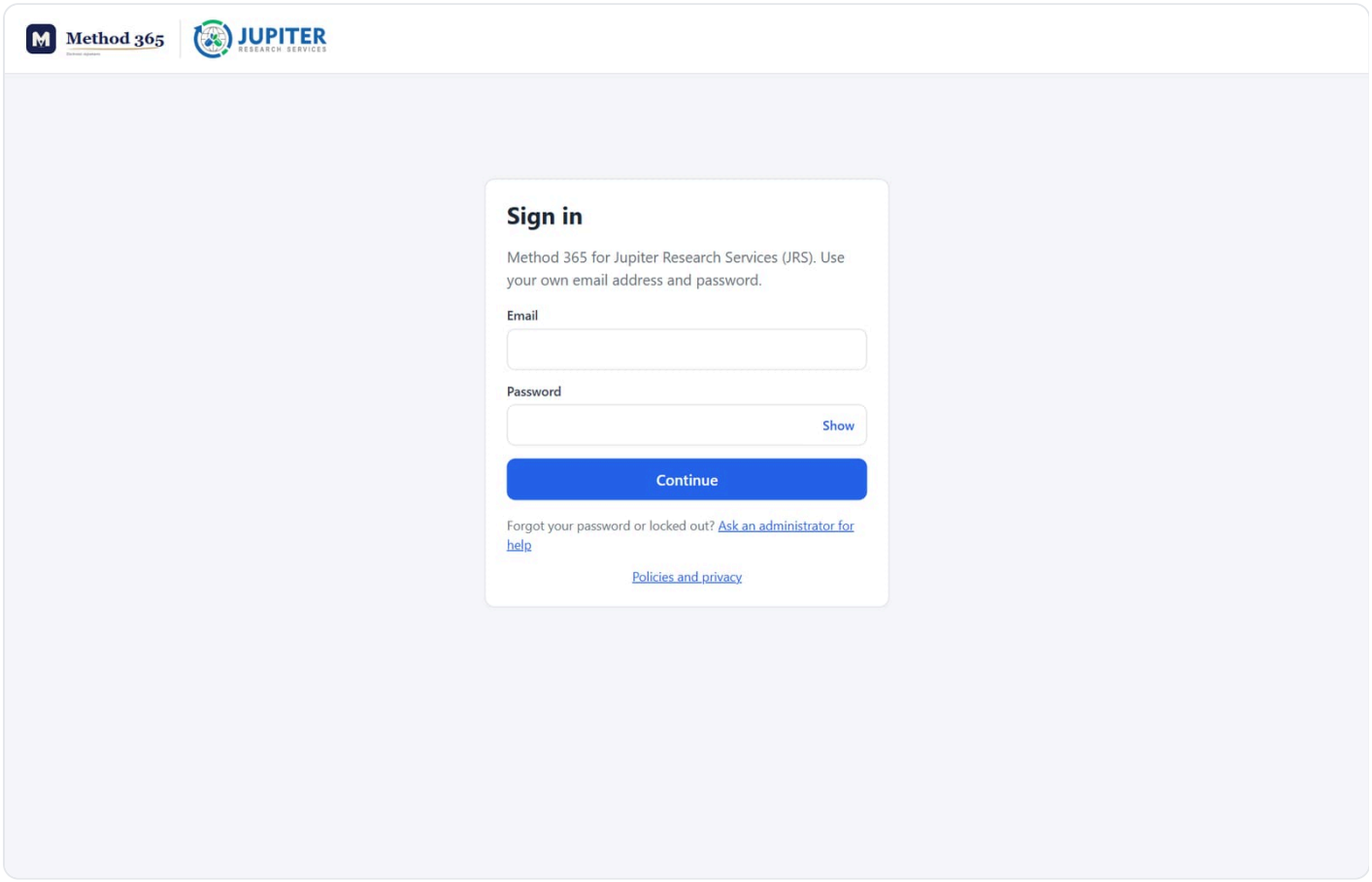


Figure 2. The sign-in page.

- Your administrator creates your account and emails you your sign-in ID and password.
- After 5 wrong passwords in a row your account locks for 15 minutes.
- You're signed out after 30 minutes without activity.

Forgot your password or locked out? Click *Ask an administrator for help* on the sign-in page. You get a case number, and an administrator fixes it and emails you.

My profile

Click your name at the top right. Set your title, company and a default signature. The signing page offers them for you to confirm; they're never applied without your click.

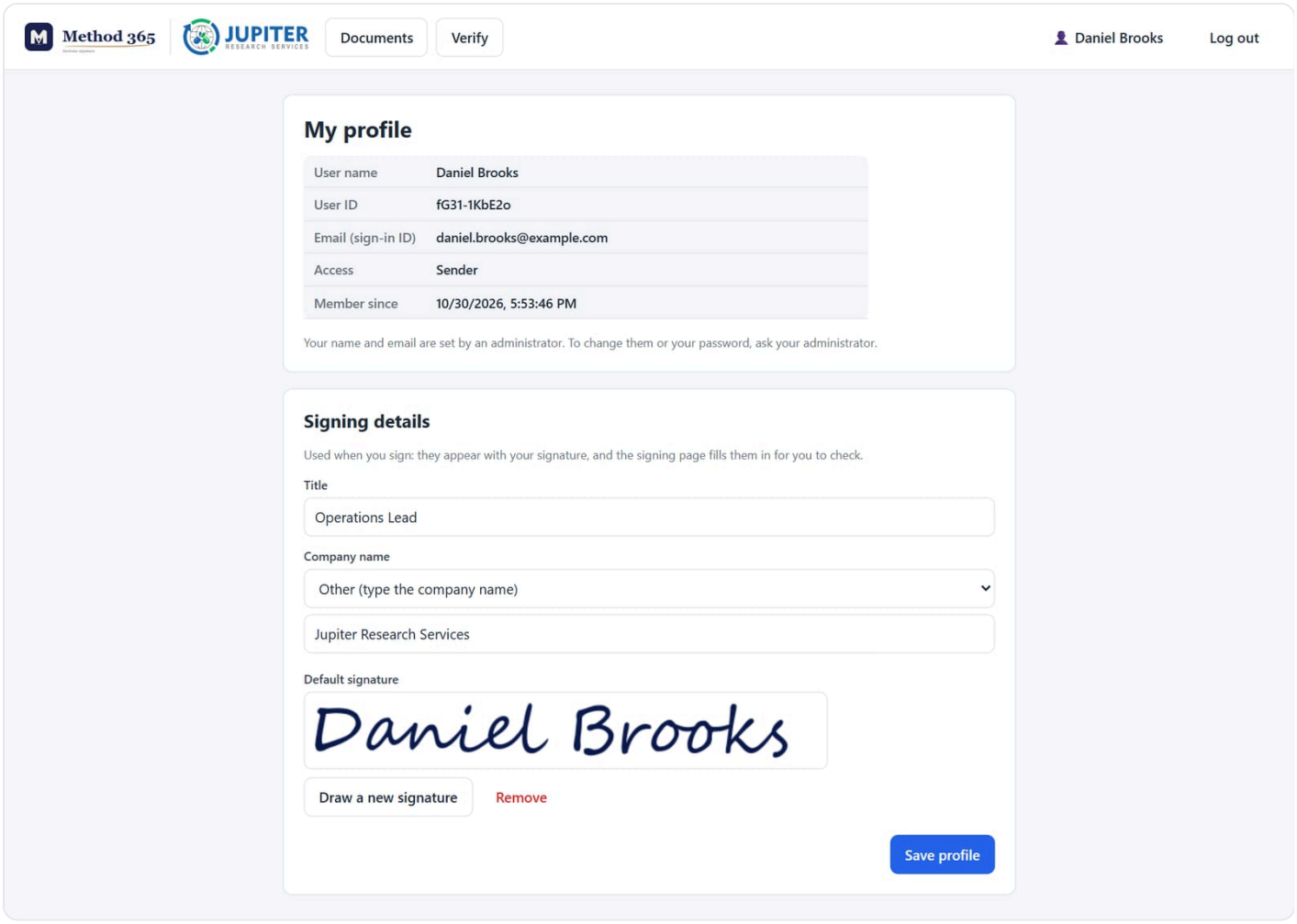


Figure 3. My profile.

3. Sending an agreement

Step 1: upload the files

On **Documents**, drop files on the upload box or click it. Choose several files of different types to merge them into one agreement.

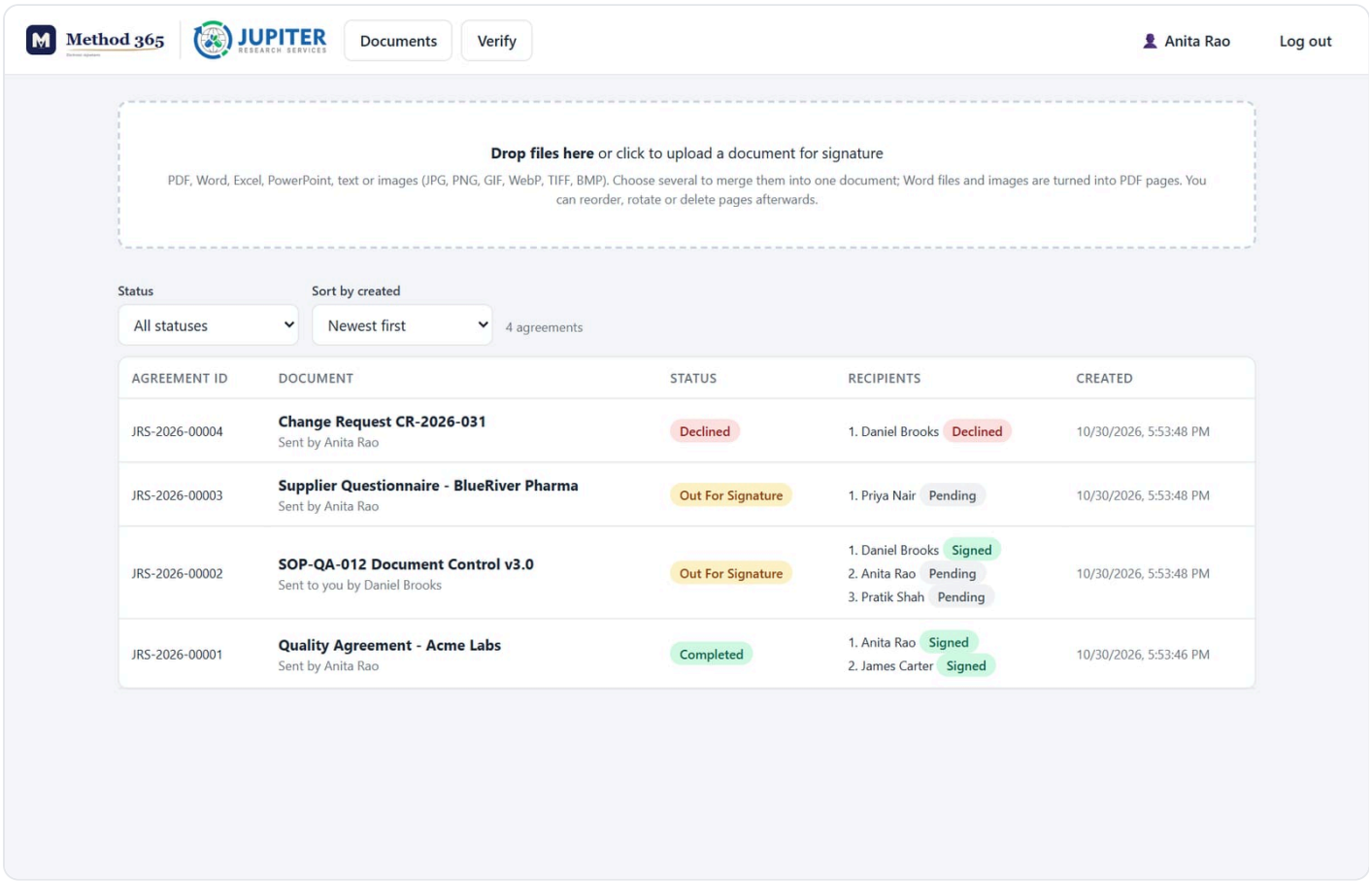


Figure 4. Documents: the upload box and your agreements.

YOU UPLOAD	WHAT HAPPENS
PDF	Used as it is
Word, Excel, PowerPoint, text	Turned into PDF pages. Check them: a missing font can shift the layout slightly.
Images (JPG, PNG, GIF, WebP, TIFF, BMP)	One A4 page per image, turned upright
iPhone HEIC photo	Refused: share it as JPG instead

Step 2: add recipients and fields

1. Under **Add recipients**, click **+ Add recipient** and enter each person's full name and email.
2. Choose the **signing order**: *One after another* (for "performed by → checked by → QA approval") or *Everyone at once*.

3. Under **Fields for**, pick the recipient, click a field type such as *E-signature*, then click on the page to place it. Drag to move; drag the corner to resize.
4. Copy a field with `Ctrl` + `C` and paste with `Ctrl` + `V`.

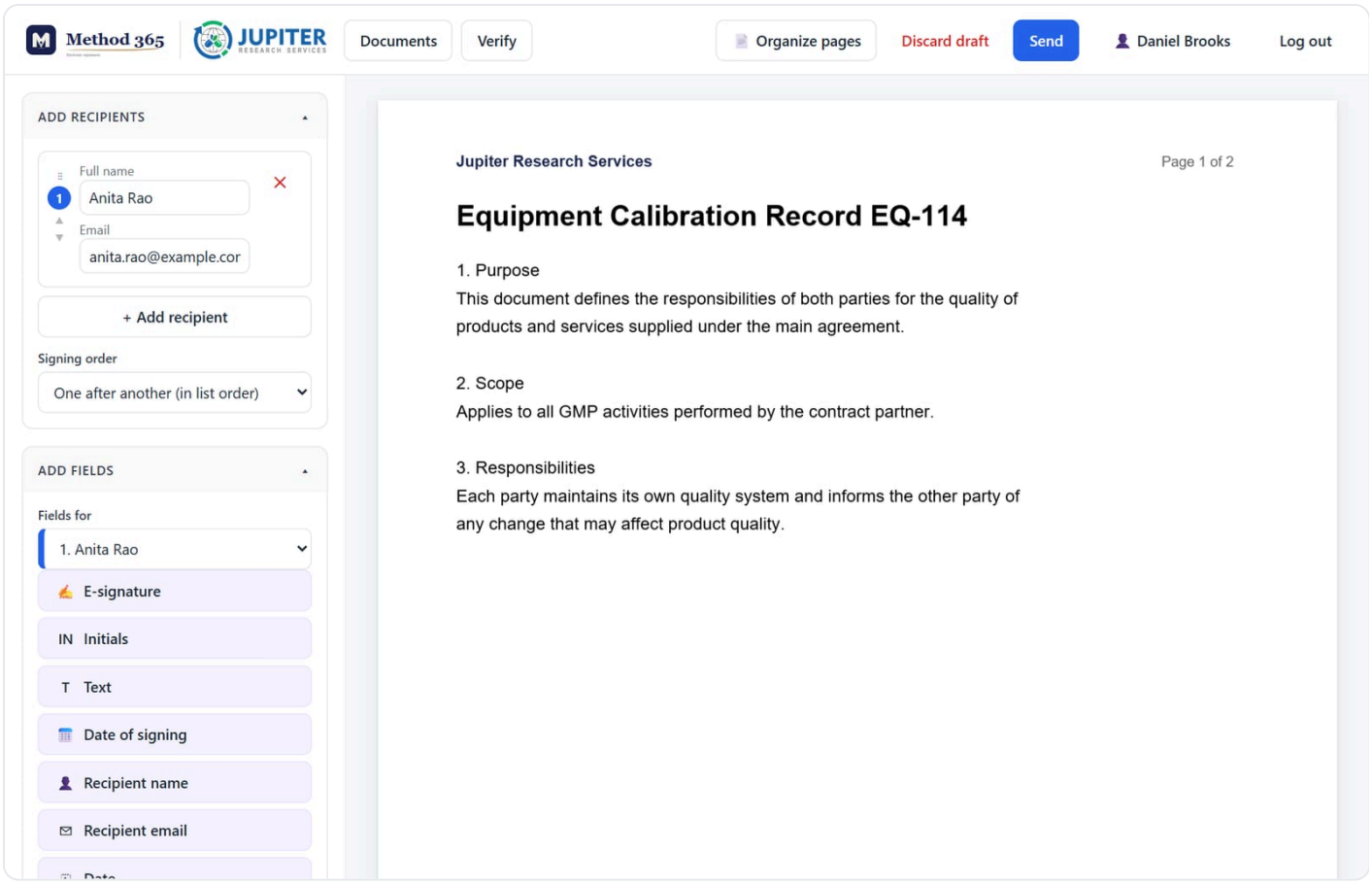


Figure 5. The editor: recipients and fields on the left, the document on the right.

> Every recipient needs at least one E-signature field. Every signer must give a reason (the meaning of their signature); this can't be switched off.

Step 3: organize pages (optional)

Click **Organize pages** to drag pages into order, rotate or delete them, or **+ Add files** to merge in more.

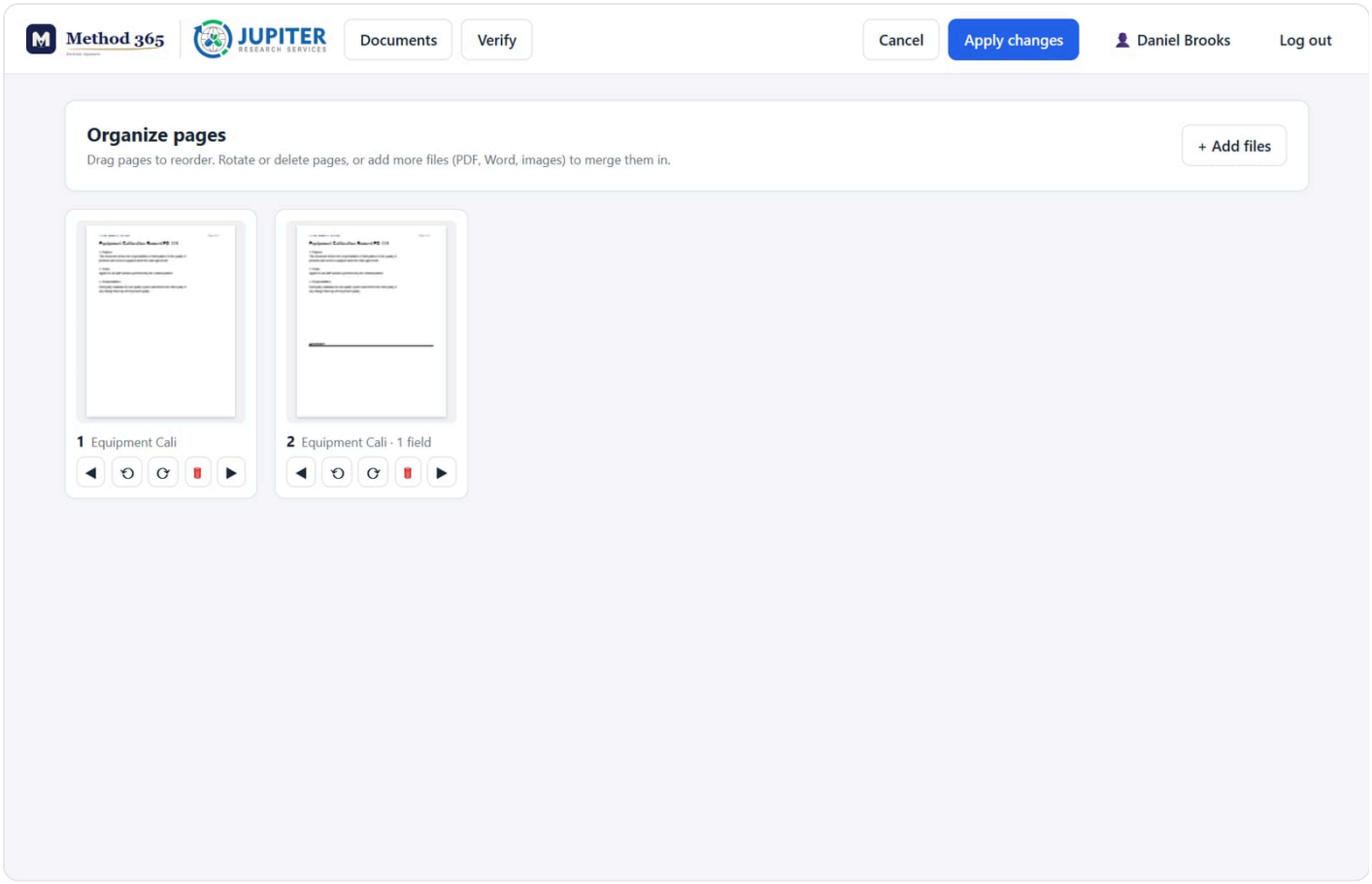


Figure 6. Organize pages.

Step 4: send

Click **Send**. The agreement gets its ID (for example JRS-2026-00014) and the first signer(s) are emailed a personal link.

4. Tracking agreements

Open an agreement from **Documents** to see each recipient's status, their signing link and the audit trail.

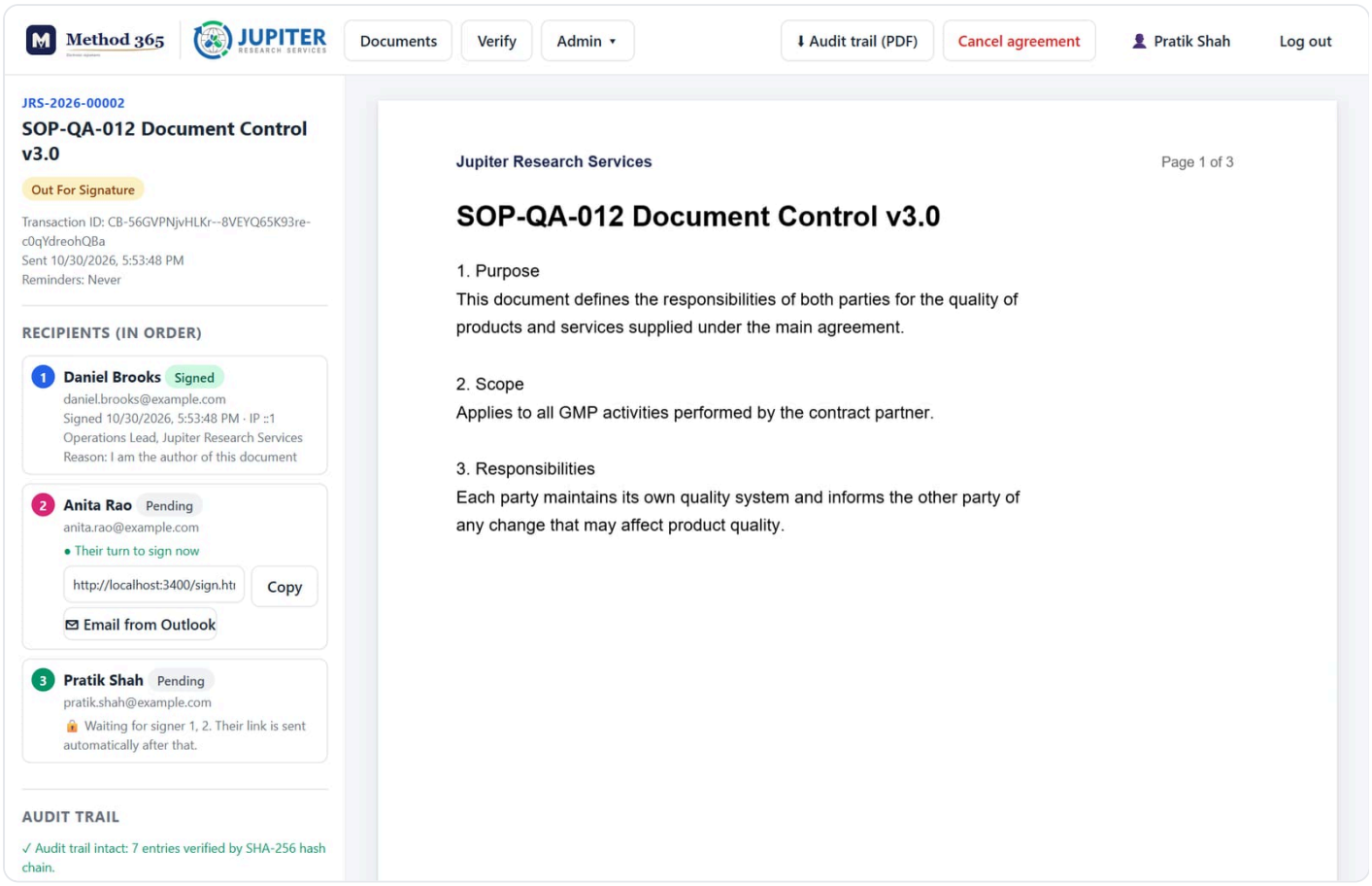


Figure 7. An agreement out for signature: the first signer has signed, the next one is invited.

STATUS	MEANING
Draft	Not sent; you can still edit or discard it
Out for signature	Sent; waiting for one or more signers
Completed	Everyone signed; the signed PDF is ready
Declined	A signer declined, with a reason
Cancelled	Cancelled by the sender or an administrator, with a reason

- **Send reminder** emails the signer their link again.
- **Email from Outlook** opens a ready-written email with the signer's link, from your own mailbox.
- **Copy** (beside a link) lets you share it yourself. Each link works only for its invited person.
- **Cancel agreement** asks for a reason. Sent agreements can't be deleted.

5. Signing an agreement

Only the person the agreement was sent to can sign it. How you prove who you are depends on whether you have a Method 365 account:

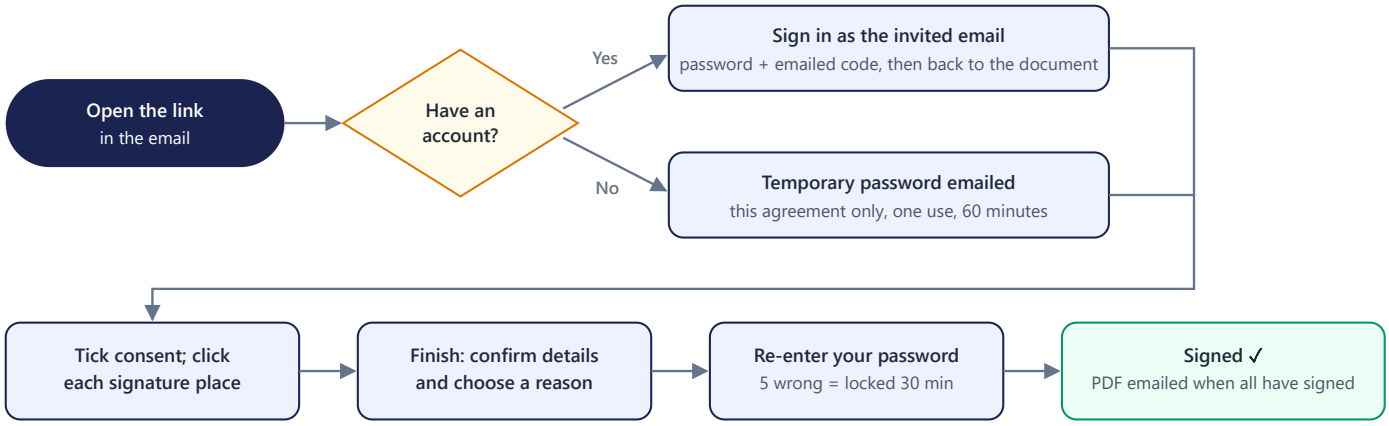


Figure 8. How signing works, with and without an account.

If you have an account

Open the link in the email. If you're not signed in, click **Sign in as …**; after sign-in you return to the document. If you're signed in as someone else, log out first.

If you don't have an account

Open the link. A temporary password is emailed to you. It works once, for this agreement only, for 60 minutes. Didn't get it? Click **Send a new temporary password**.

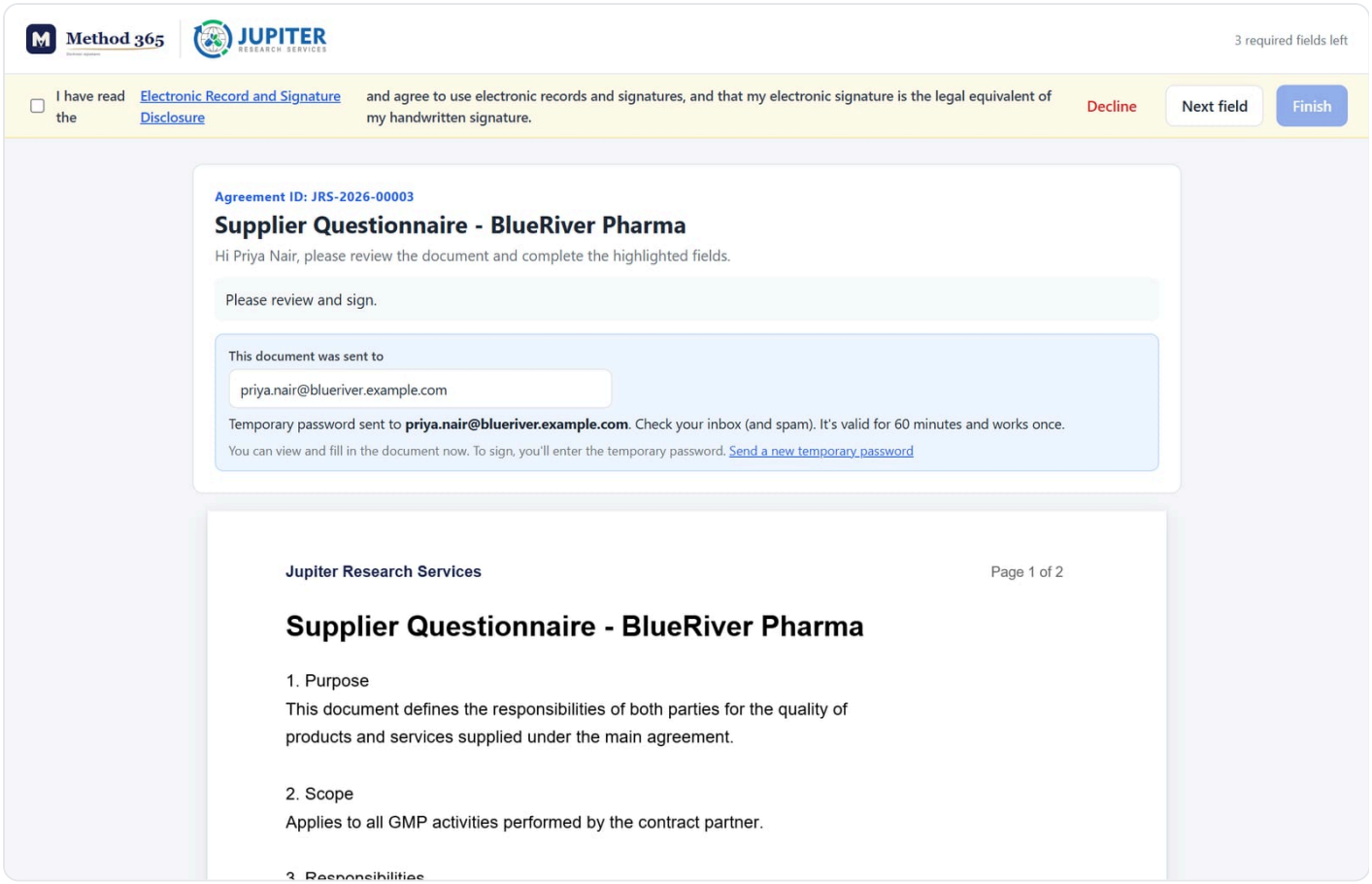


Figure 9. Signing without an account: the temporary password is sent to your email.

Signing step by step

1. Read the document and tick the box agreeing to use electronic records and signatures.
2. Click the first signature place and adopt your signature: use your saved one, draw, type or upload.
3. **Click each other signature place.** Each signs on your click, with no retyping, so you see every place you sign. **Next field** takes you to the next one.
4. Click **Finish**, confirm your title and company, and choose the reason for signing.
5. Enter your password (account password or temporary password) and click **Sign**.

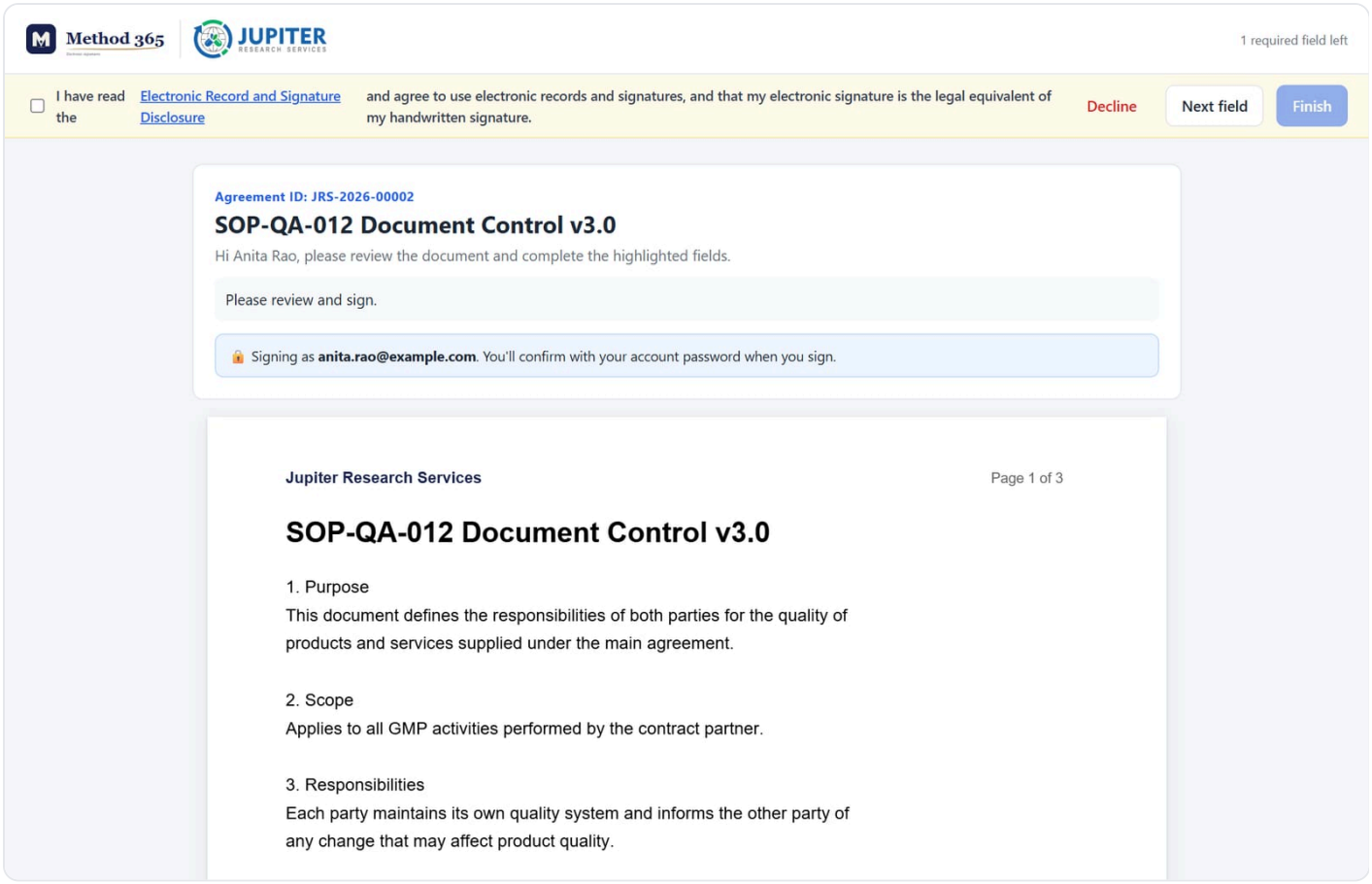


Figure 10. The signing page for an account holder.

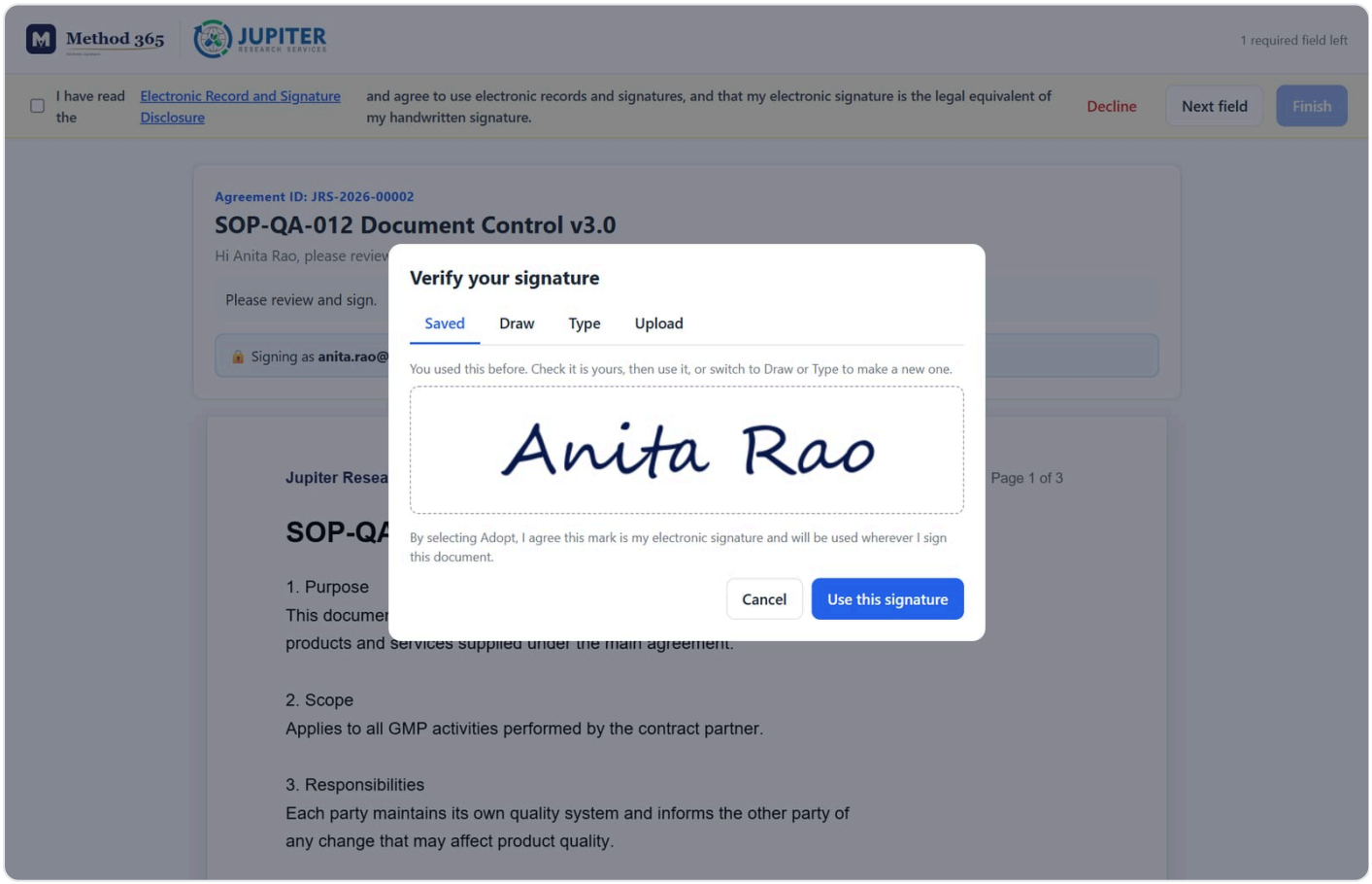


Figure 11. Adopting your signature (here, the saved one).

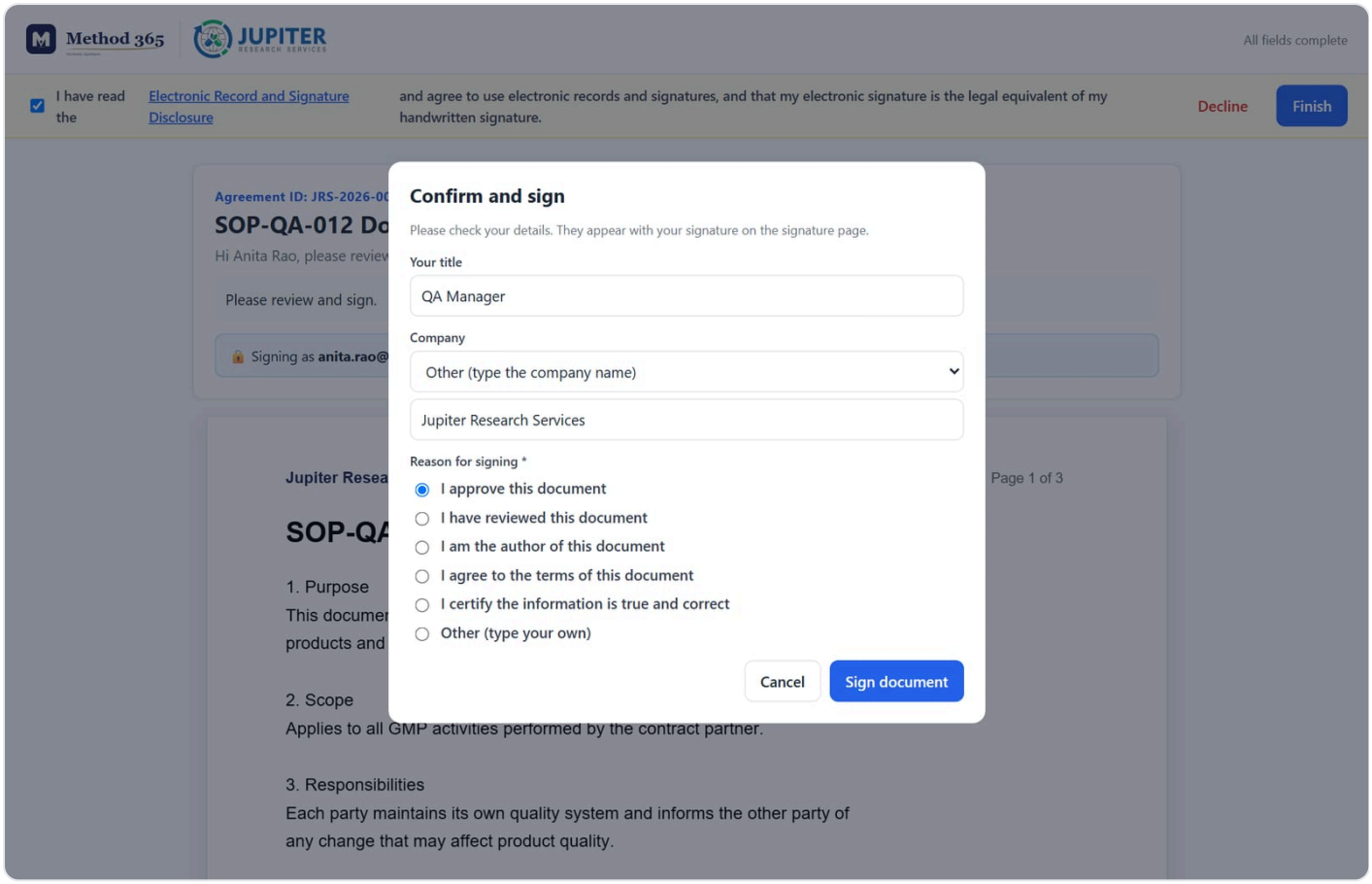


Figure 12. Confirm your details and the reason (meaning) of your signature.

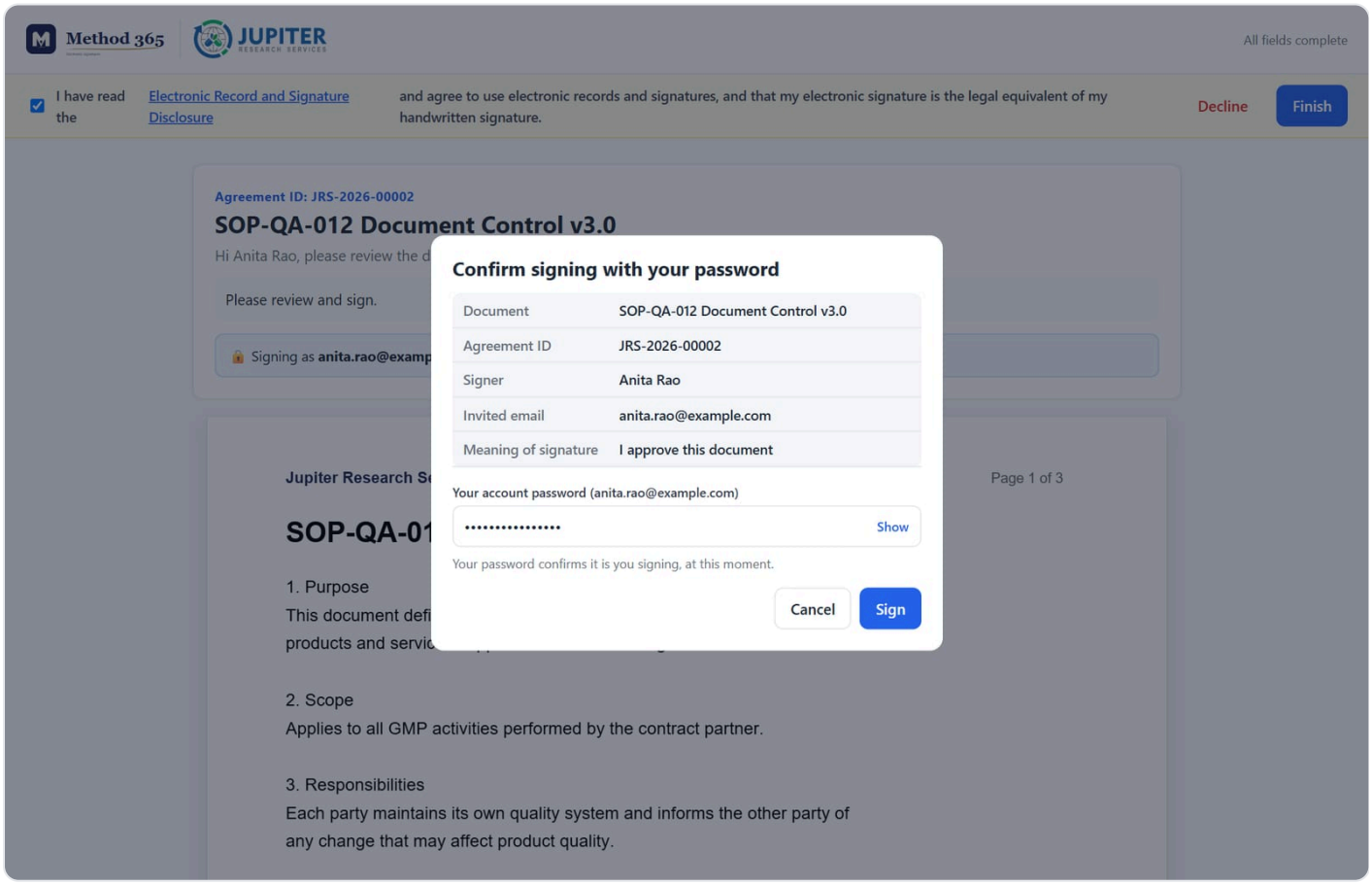


Figure 13. Re-enter your password to sign.

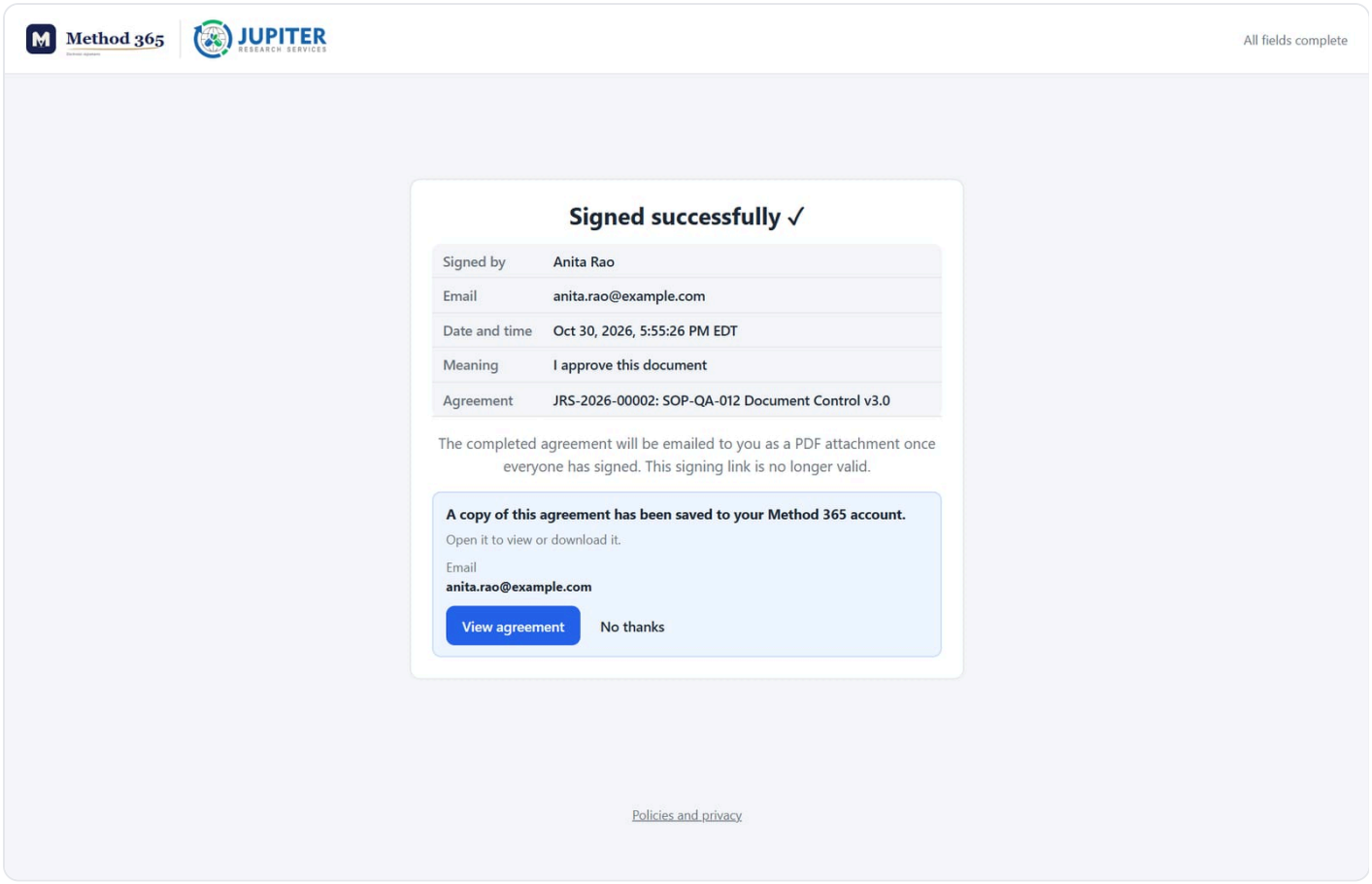


Figure 14. Signed. With an account, View agreement (or Log in) opens it any time.

Declining: click **Decline**, give a reason and enter your password. The agreement closes and the sender is told.

Without an account, after signing you can click **Yes, request an account**; you get a case number and an administrator follows up.

6. Completed agreements

A completed agreement is a locked PDF, certified by Jupiter Research Services and digitally signed by each signer. Nobody can change or delete it.

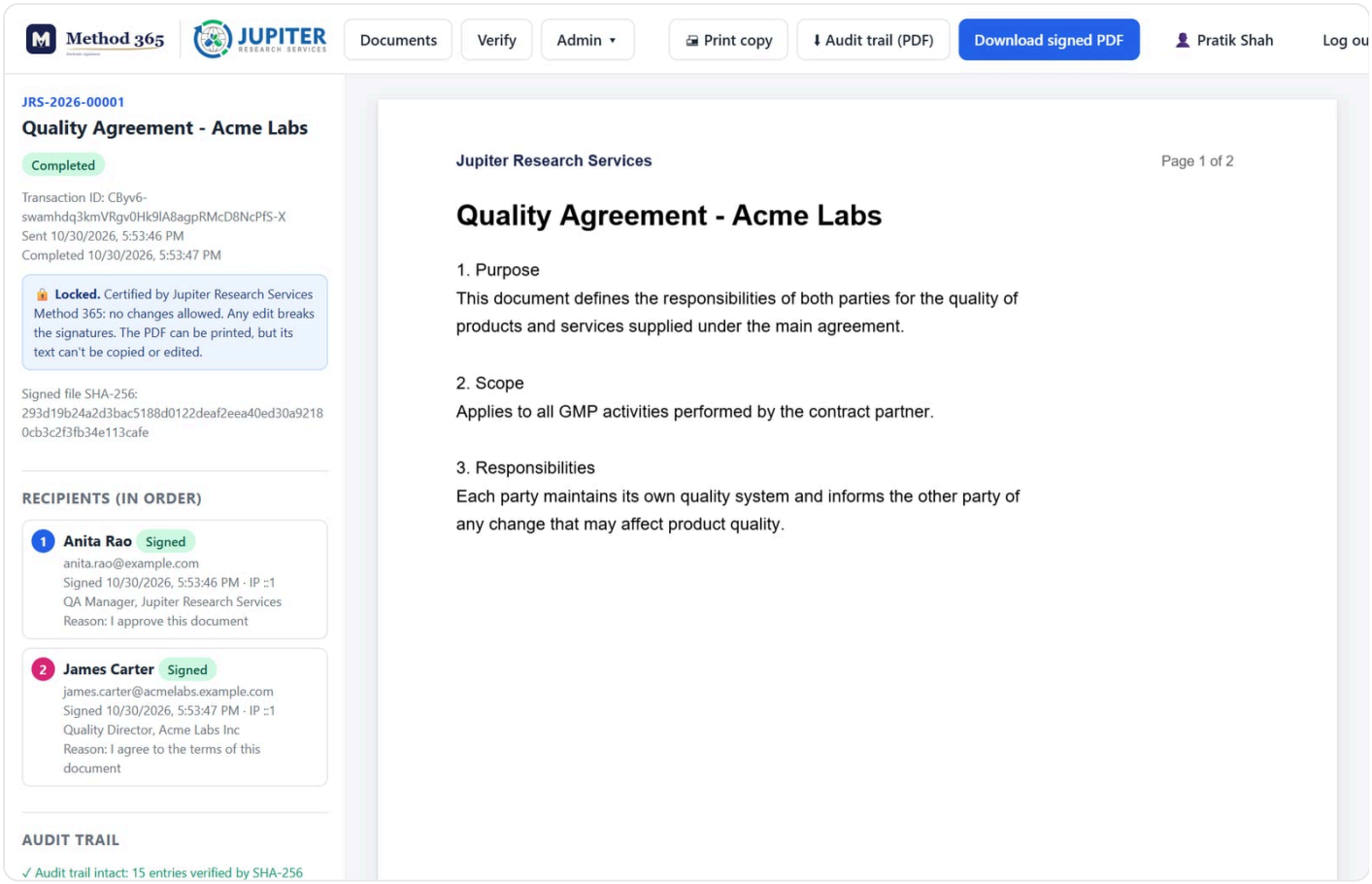


Figure 15. A completed agreement: Download signed PDF, Print copy and Audit trail (PDF).

- **Download signed PDF**: opens without a password; it can be printed but its text can't be copied or edited.
- **Print copy**: a stamped copy showing who printed it, when, and a link to verify it.
- **Audit trail**: every event with date, time, who, IP address and how the person proved who they were. Choose *From* and *To* to see or download one period.

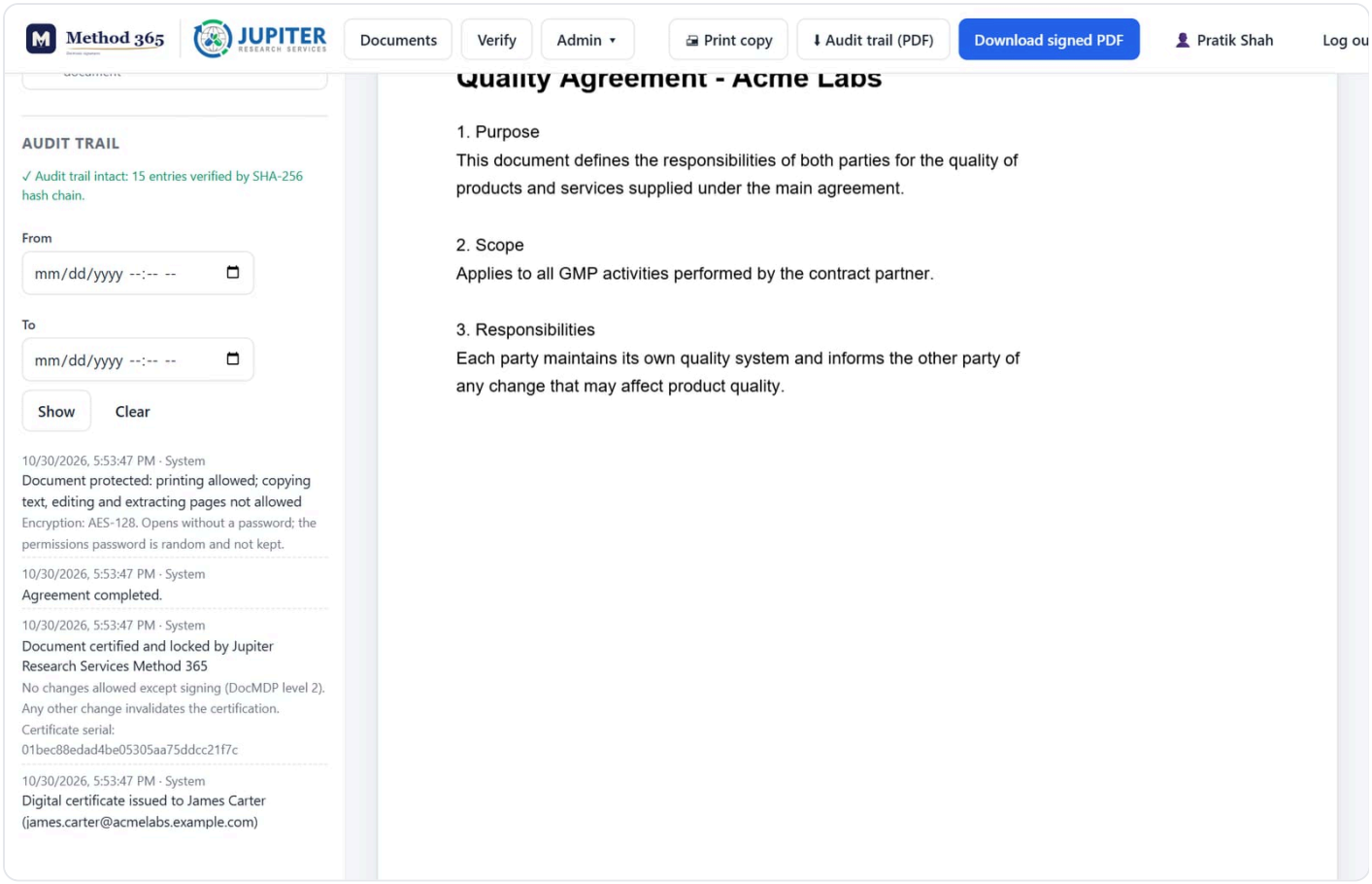


Figure 16. The audit trail, with its integrity check.

Verify a signed PDF

Anyone can check a signed PDF on the **Verify** page: an unchanged original shows as valid with its agreement ID and signers.

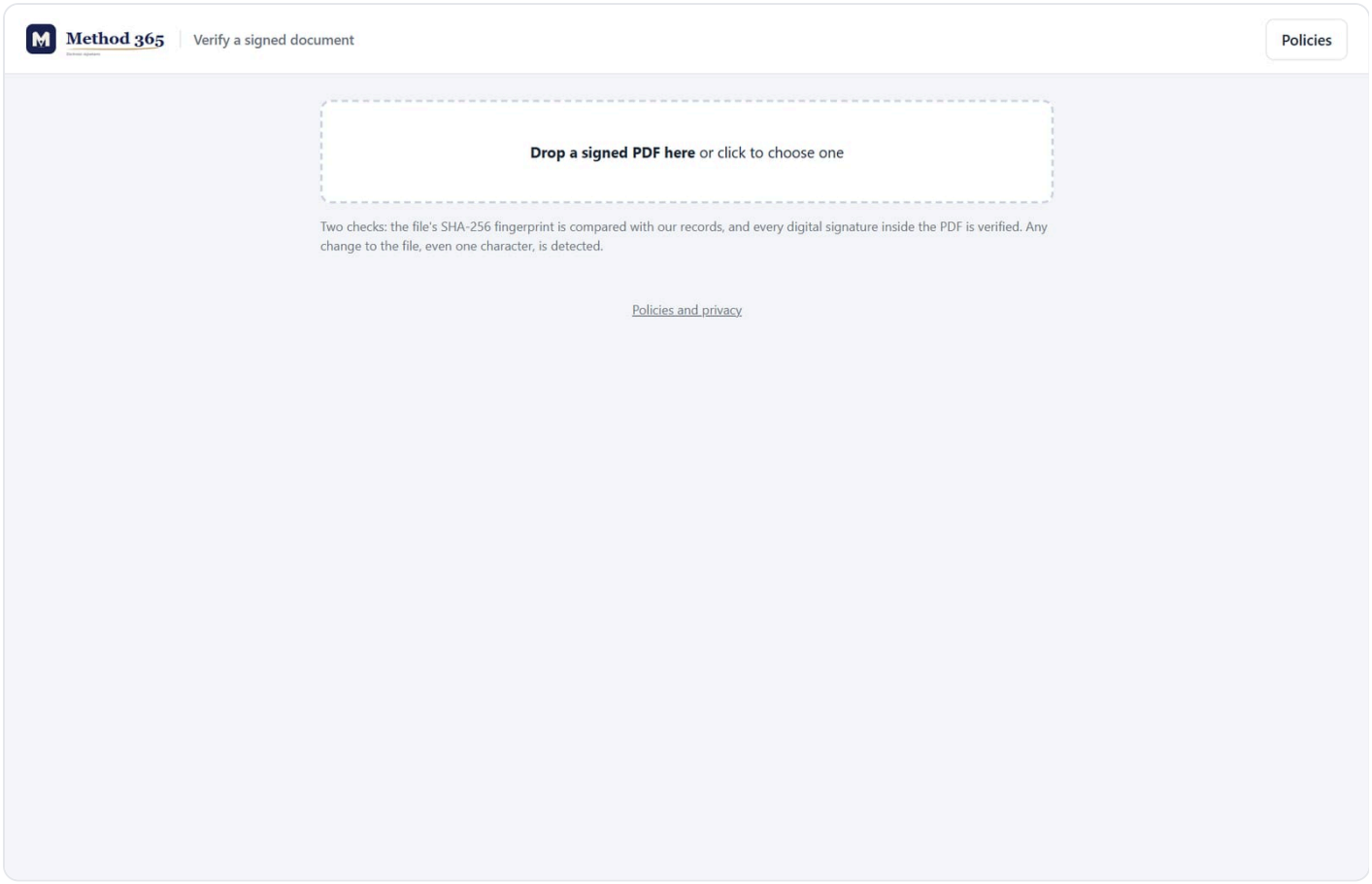


Figure 17. Verify a signed document.

7. Administration

The **Admin** ▾ menu appears for administrators only. Everything done here is recorded in the system log.

Users

- **Add a user**: name, email and access. **Generate** fills in a strong password; the person is emailed their sign-in details.
- **Edit**, **Set new password**, and audit-trail **View**/**Download** permissions per user.
- **Deactivate** instead of deleting, so names stay in every audit trail.
- **Outside signers** lists people who signed without an account; **Create account** fills in the add-user form.

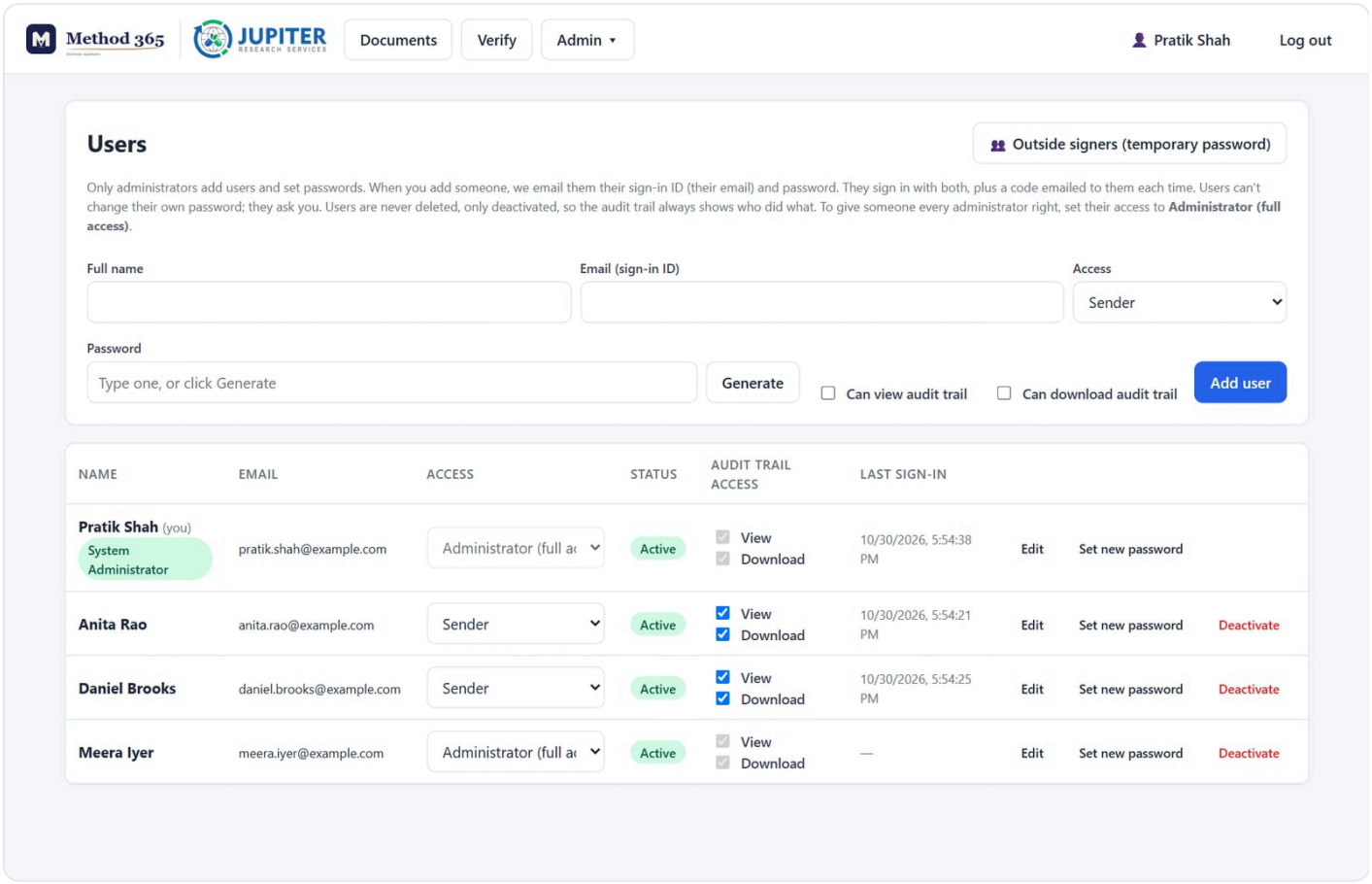


Figure 18. Users.

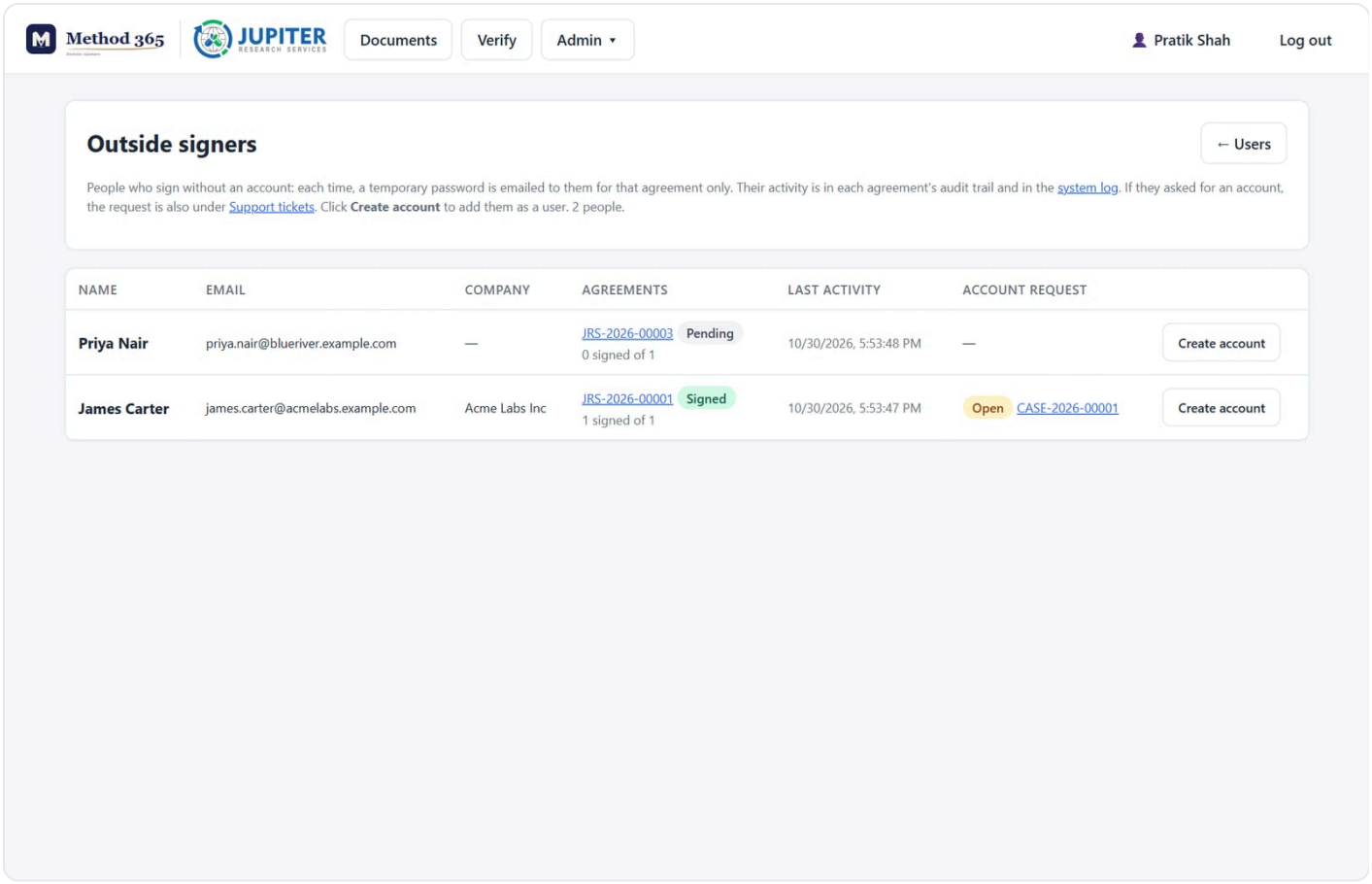


Figure 19. Outside signers and their account requests.

Support tickets

Sign-in problems and account requests arrive with a case number. Fix the problem, then **Resolve** with a note; the person is emailed.

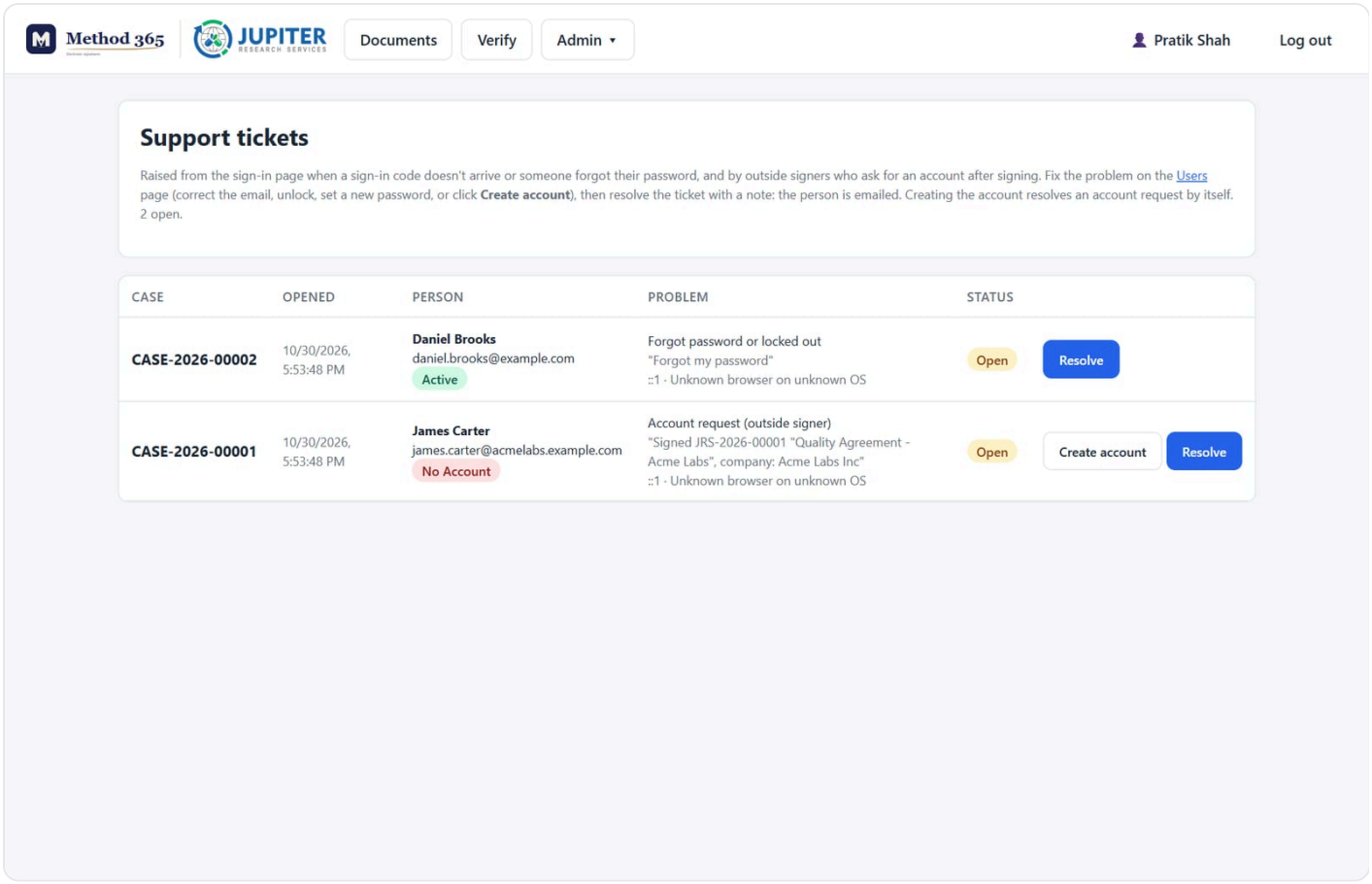


Figure 20. Support tickets.

System log

Sign-ins, failed attempts, locks, user changes, backups, restarts and outside signers' activity, with an integrity check. Filter by time and download as PDF.

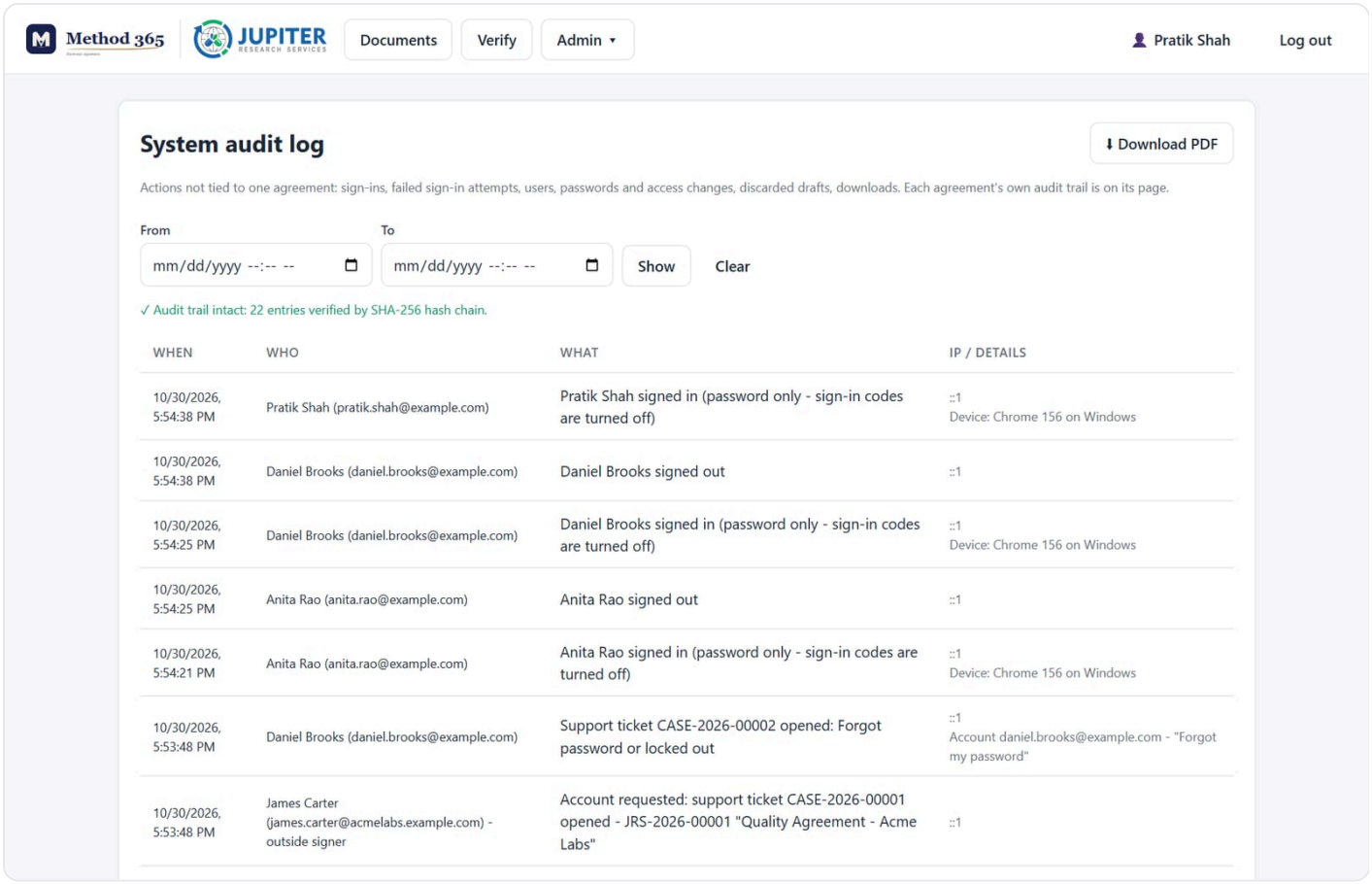


Figure 21. The system log.

Backup and restore

- **Download backup to this computer** or **Save a backup on the server now**.
- **Automatic backups**: off, every few hours, daily or weekly at a set time; production servers back up daily at 02:00 unless changed.
- **Restore** needs your password, first saves the current data as a restore point, and signs everyone out.

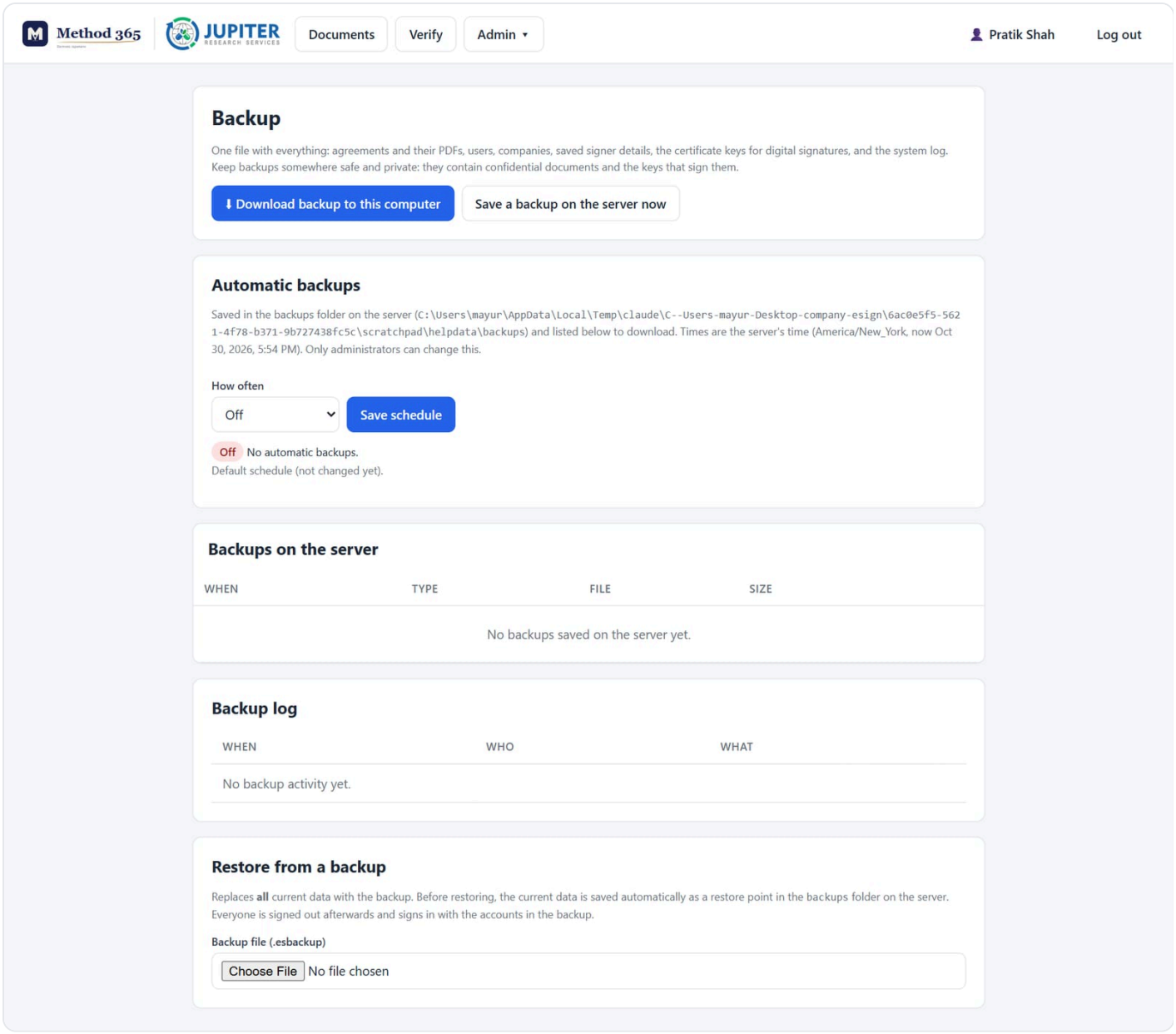


Figure 22. Backup and restore, with the schedule, backups on the server and the backup log.

Server restart (system administrator only)

Back up, update and restart saves a backup, gets the newest code, checks it and restarts. If the update fails, nothing restarts. Production servers can't erase their data.

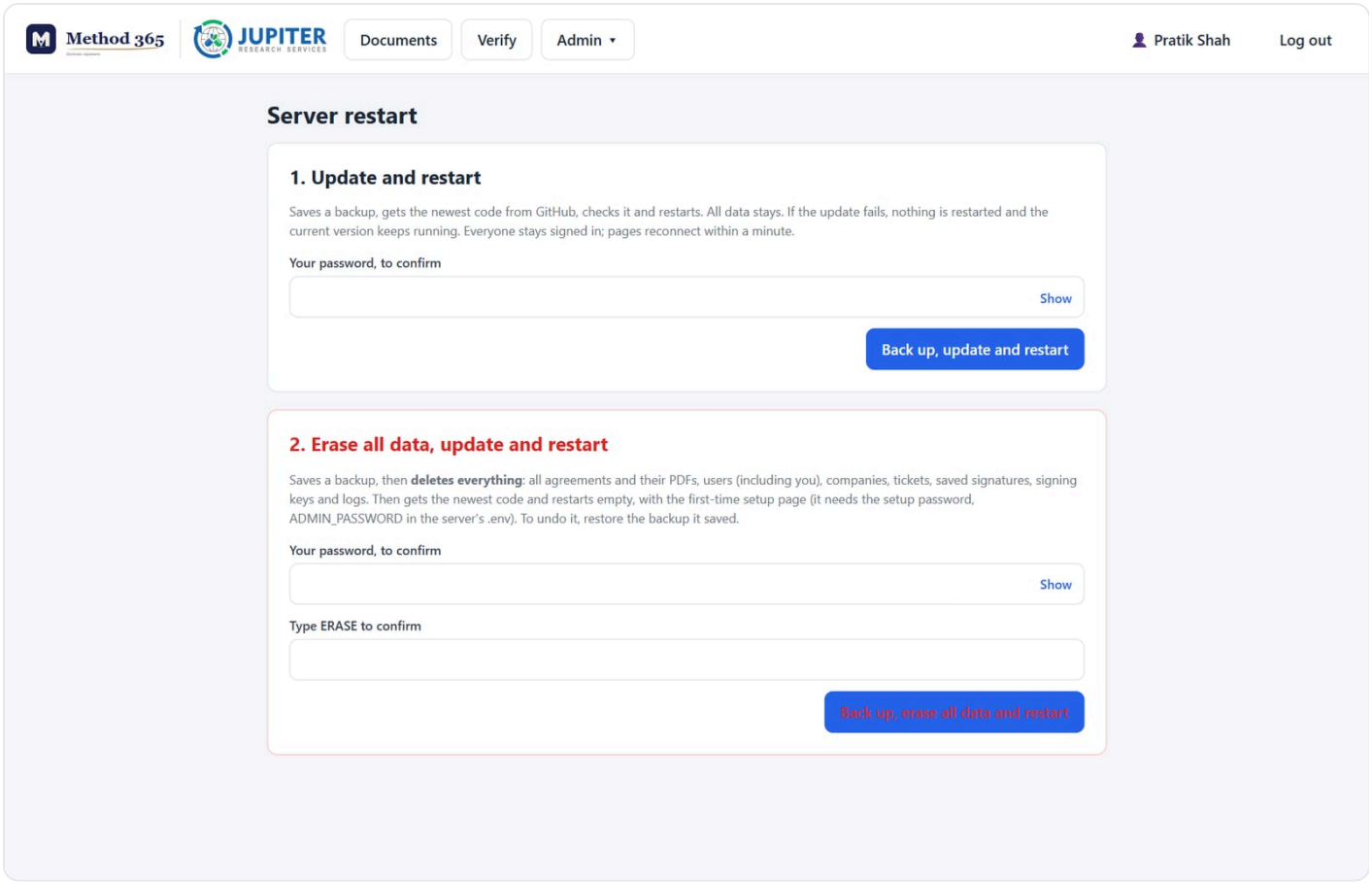


Figure 23. Server restart.

8. Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
Code or signing email didn't arrive	Check junk/spam and send a new one. Senders can use **Email from Outlook**. Still missing: raise a sign-in help ticket.
“Account locked”	Wait 15 minutes, or ask an administrator to unlock it.
“Signing is locked”	Wait 30 minutes, then try again or send yourself a new temporary password.
“You are logged in as … but this document was sent to …”	Log out and sign in with the email the agreement was sent to.
“This link is no longer valid”	You've already signed. The signed PDF is emailed when everyone has signed; with an account, use **Log in to view**.
Upload refused	Use PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, text or common image files. iPhone HEIC photos: share as JPG.
Everyone signed but no signed PDF	Signatures are kept. An administrator opens the agreement and clicks **Retry completion**.
The site doesn't open	Tell the system administrator.